



A STUDENT walks by Pomona College. A series of anti-Black incidents has unsettled the close-knit campus.

Justice Dept. drops Powell inquiry

The move may clear a roadblock for Trump’s nominee to chair the Federal Reserve.

By BEN WIEDER AND GAVIN J. QUINTON

WASHINGTON — In a surprising about-face, Jeanine Pirro, the U.S. attorney for the District of Columbia, announced Friday that she would be dropping an investigation into Federal Reserve Chairman Jerome H. Powell that critics had labeled as politically motivated since it became public in January.

That investigation, which focused on whether Powell had lied to Congress about the \$2.5-billion renovation of the central bank’s headquarters, had emerged as a stumbling block in President Trump’s effort to install his pick to succeed Powell.

Sen. Thom Tillis (R-N.C.) had said he would block the nomination of Kevin Warsh to be the next chairman of the Federal Reserve as long as the Powell investigation continued.

While the Justice Department’s investigation is now closed, the bank’s inspector general will take on the investigation into the costly renovations instead, and Pirro did not rule out the possibility of resuming her criminal investigation.

“Note well, however, that I will not hesitate to restart a criminal investigation should the facts warrant doing so,” Pirro wrote on X.

White House spokeswoman Karoline Leavitt also told reporters later that Pirro’s announcement did not signal the end of the investigation.

“This has been a priority for the president,” she said. Tillis did not respond to requests for comment.

Powell was first appointed to the role by Trump in 2017 but fell out of the president’s favor by resisting his pressure campaign to lower interest rates.

The bank has historically enjoyed greater independence than other federal agencies to insulate its decision-making from political influence.

The limits of the bank’s independence are currently being tested by Trump’s attempt last August to fire one of Powell’s colleagues, Federal Reserve Governor Lisa Cook, over allegations that she committed mortgage fraud.

Cook protested her firing and the Supreme Court [See Powell, A6]

‘In-your-face racism’ felt at Pomona College

Investigations of several incidents are underway

By JAWEED KALEEM

Pomona College in Claremont has long projected the ideals of a liberal arts education: elite academics, small classes and deep student-faculty ties against a backdrop of lush courtyards at one of the nation’s most selective campuses. That image is now under strain.

A series of anti-Black incidents has unsettled the campus, raising questions about race and belonging. This year, multiple students have shouted or sung the N-word at athletic events and in residential halls, and held a party where attendees were invited to dress as Black stereotypes. Criticism is growing over a professor’s use of the slur in class. Vandals damaged a campus lounge popular with Black community members.

Students have also pointed to Fizz, an anonymous app used by Pomona students and those across the other neighboring undergraduate Claremont Colleges — Pitzer, Harvey Mudd, Claremont McKenna and Scripps — as a place where racist posts regularly circulate.

The college has confirmed several of the cases took place and said it is aware of reports of others while investigations are underway.

“Pomona College does not care or protect their Black students,” said a recent Instagram video from the Black Student Union that was shared thousands of times.

Black students say the racist episodes are not isolated but part of a pattern that has eroded trust as national politics intensify scrutiny of diversity, equity and inclusion efforts and, in particular, Black and Latino student enrollment at elite colleges.

“I grew up in suburban Indiana, so I thought I was used to being one of the few Black people around and the snickers and sneers,” said Kourtney Jennings, a junior majoring in media studies and politics. “What I did not expect is to encounter such in-your-face racism in Southern California.” [See Racism, A9]

This could get complicated

West Hollywood and other cities seek to bless polyamorous unions. Lawyers warn of messy court fights.

By SONJA SHARP



ALANA CHAZAN, left, and Amira Hasenbush work on polyamory cases at All Family Legal in Glendale.

Nurses raced around Chloe, prepping the Oakland mother-to-be for a caesarean. One minute, she’d been in the bathroom, laboring through a contraction. The next, she was being rushed into emergency surgery, her daughter’s heart rate dropping precipitously on the fetal monitor.

The new mom, who asked that she and her family be identified only by their first names out of fear they could be targeted for the unconventional way they’re raising their daughter, said her doctors had known for weeks that she would probably end up with a surgical birth.

Yet because of their uncommon family structure, it wasn’t until just minutes before the obstetrician cut into her belly that the father of her child got permission to go with her into the operating room.

“They were changing [See Polyamorous, A8]

Family says systems failed them before father-son murder-suicide

By GRACE TOOHEY

There wasn’t one misstep or a single failure that led to the tragedy that will forever haunt Frank Perez.

But when he learned that his son — his loving yet tortured son who struggled with severe mental illness — fatally shot his beloved 11-year-old grandson before turning the gun on himself earlier this month at a Nevada airport, Perez couldn’t help but think of all the missed opportunities that preceded the horrific shooting.

“We were crying for help,” Perez said. “We tried to get

him help.”

For years, and more urgently in recent months, Perez said their family had tried to better protect Callan, 11, and get his father, 37-year-old Giovanni Perez, the help he needed. But at every turn, the senior Perez said he felt like they hit roadblocks in complicated mental health and family court systems.

“I always feared something would happen like this,” Perez said. But he said he can’t simply blame his son, who had been hospitalized several times since returning from a military deployment, diagnosed with PTSD.

Instead, Perez sees a web of failed systems: narrow services for military veterans, limited mental health treatment options, insufficient gun restrictions and not enough protections for children living with unstable parents.

“He loved Callan,” Perez said of his son. “He would just have these bouts of mental illness, and unfortunately, this time it won. ... He would have episodes of psychosis and see things, and I believe that’s what happened that day. It wasn’t him who did that.”

Local police investigating the April 13 shooting in [See Systems, A9]

Pratt and Raman top Bass in latest fundraising in mayoral contest

By NOAH GOLDBERG AND DAVID ZAHNISER

Los Angeles Mayor Karen Bass is up against three well-financed challengers in the June 2 primary, with reality television star Spencer Pratt and Councilmember Nithya Raman leading the pack in fundraising since the start of the year.

Pratt, whose home was destroyed in the 2025 Palisades fire, has raised nearly \$540,000 for his campaign since Jan. 1, according to figures reported this week to the city’s Ethics Commission.

Raman, who joined the race in February, has brought in \$530,000 in contributions through the April 18 filing period, much of it from writers, producers and others in the entertainment industry, the city’s numbers show.

Bass reported taking in nearly \$495,000 since Jan. 1. She began fundraising for reelection in 2024, however, and still has nearly \$2.3 million in cash on hand.

A fourth candidate, tech entrepreneur Adam Miller, reported that he lent his campaign \$2.5 million. Miller also took in about \$200,000 in donations, reports show.

Miller has been lagging far behind Bass, Raman and Pratt in public opinion polls, which also show a large percentage of voters undecided.

Dan Schnur, a politics professor at USC, UC Berkeley and Pepperdine University, said the fundraising reports show the three highest-polling candidates evenly matched heading into the final weeks of the campaign.

“There’s no meaningful difference in the amount of money the top three candidates have raised,” he said. “The fact that Bass hasn’t raised more than her challengers as the incumbent should be of some concern to her campaign.”

The numbers also demonstrate that Pratt has become a “legitimate top-tier candidate,” Schnur said.

“The odds are still against him winning in a deep blue city, but he has the potential to make a significant impact on the race,” he said.

The mayor’s race is non-partisan, but city voters have generally elected Democrats to the job.

Because Raman and Pratt entered the race late, they still trail Bass significantly when it comes to the total amount raised.

Since launching her reelection bid, Bass has [See Mayor, A7]

Park leads Malik in money race

The L.A. City Council member has raised more than \$1.2 million in the District 11 contest. B1

Appeals court blocks asylum ban at border

By MICHAEL KUNZELMAN AND LINDSAY WHITEHURST

WASHINGTON — An appeals court on Friday blocked President Trump’s executive order suspending asylum access at the southern border of the U.S., a key pillar of the Republican president’s plan to crack down on migration.

A three-judge panel from the U.S. Court of Appeals for the District of Columbia Circuit found that immigration laws give people the right to apply for asylum at the border, and the president can’t circumvent that.

The court opinion stems from action taken by Trump on Inauguration Day in 2025, when he declared that the situation at the southern border constituted an “invasion” of America and that he was “suspending the physical entry” of migrants and their ability to seek asylum until he decides it is over.

The panel concluded that the Immigration and Nationality Act doesn’t authorize the president to remove the plaintiffs under “procedures of his own making,” allow him to suspend plaintiffs’ right to apply for asylum or curtail procedures for adjudicating [See Ban, A7]



MICHAEL OWENS Getty Images

RAMS LOOK TO FUTURE

In the surprise of the first round, they draft quarterback Ty Simpson as Stafford’s heir apparent rather than immediate help. SPORTS, B12

Firing squads in death sentences

For the first time, the Justice Department will permit shooting as a method of capital punishment. NATION, A5

Weather

A shower or two. L.A. Basin: 67/52. B8

Markets A11
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Tourism down in L.A., up in state

Wildfires, ICE raids and U.S. trade policies hurt the county as spending rallied elsewhere. BUSINESS, A10

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